

Stop Keyframing Motion Graphics by Hand in After Effects

swipe →

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1

Perspective Corner Pin: the shortcut

Open the Tracker panel in After Effects (Window > Tracker). Before anything else, set the track type to 'Perspective Corner Pin'. This setting is what locks the tracker to a flat surface across rotation, perspective changes, and full 3D movement.

Perspective Corner Pin is the option that makes planar tracking actually work. Select it first.

Tracker

Track Camera

Warp Stabilizer

Track Motion

Stabilize Motion

Motion Source: None

Track Type:

Perspective Corner Pin

☒ Position

☐ Rotation

☐ Scale

Motion Target: None

Edit Target...

Options...

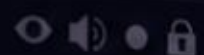
Analyze:



Reset

Apply

0:00:02:15
(23.976 fps)



Is:

Layer Name

Mode

1

Screen_Placeholder

Normal

2

Null 1

Normal

3

BG_Environment

Normal

00s

01s

02s

03s

04s

05s

2

Draw the mask, hit Analyze Forward

Draw a mask around the surface you want to track - a phone screen, a wall, a hand holding an object. Hit 'Analyze Forward' and let After Effects read every frame of movement automatically.

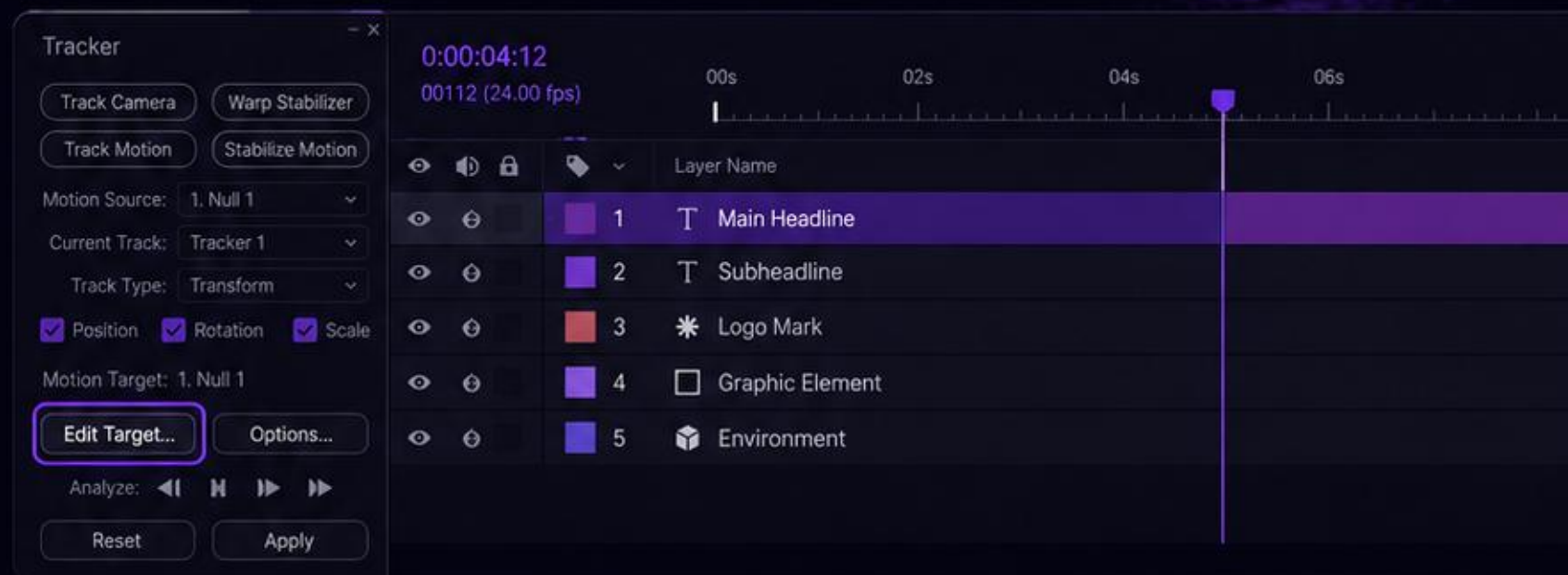
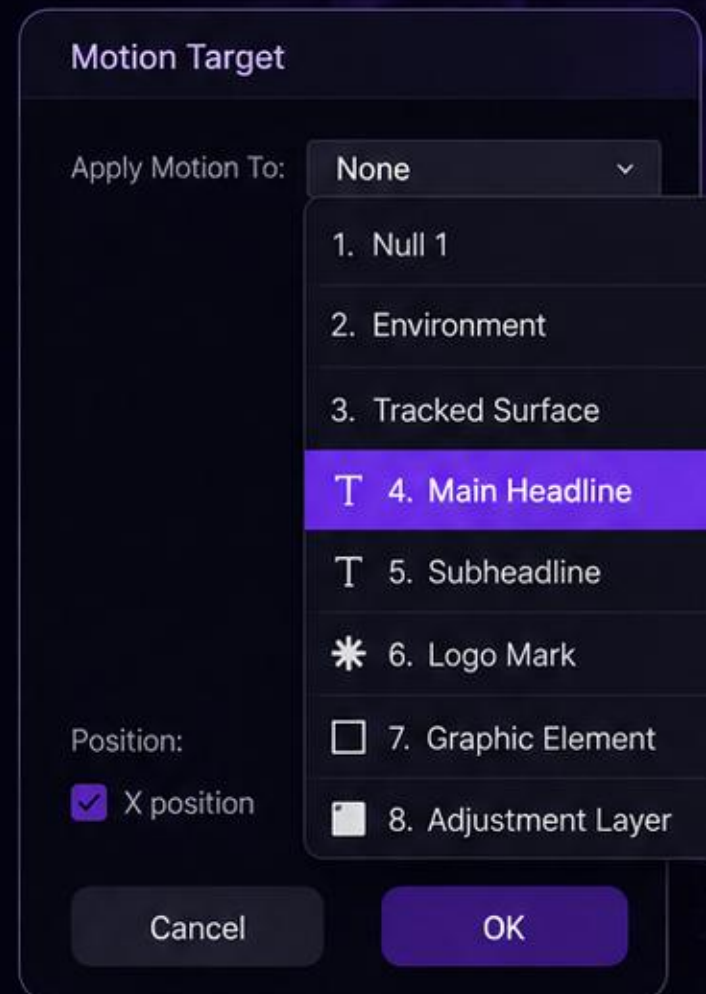


The mask tells the tracker exactly which surface to follow. Tighter masks produce cleaner tracking data.

3

Edit Target, link the layer

Once analysis is done, click 'Edit Target' in the Tracker panel. Select the layer you want to pin to the tracked surface — your text layer, a graphic, a logo. Apply the tracking data.

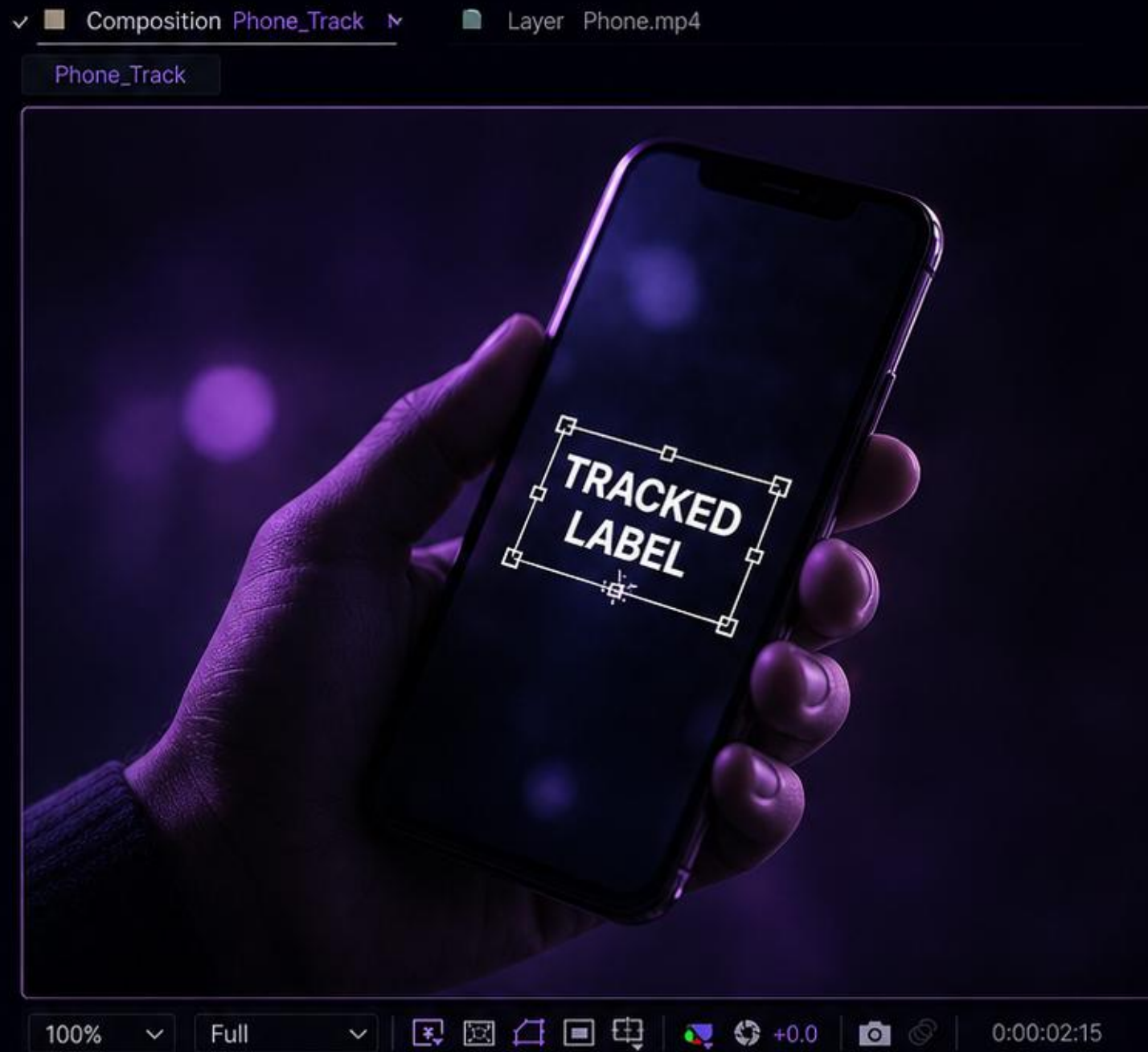


Apply the track to your graphic layer. It now follows the surface movement exactly through every frame.

4

Position, trim, and check.

Place your text or element exactly where you want it on the tracked surface. Scrub through the clip at a few key points to confirm the track is holding. Trim to the frames you need.



▼ Main Comp

0:00:02:15
00063 (30.00 fps)

8

Parent & Link
None

TRACKED LABEL

Transform

Anchor Point	540.0, 960.0
Position	538.7, 964.3
Scale	100.0, 100.0 %
Rotation	0x+0.0°
Opacity	100 %

00:00f 01:00f 02:00f 03:00f 04:00f 05:00f

TRACKED LABEL

✳ *Scrub to the middle and end of the clip to catch any tracking drift before the final export.*

Save this.

*Video editing techniques, AI tools,
and workflow breakdowns.*

Ananda Paramanick

YouTube Video Editor

